

Ideation Phase

Project Title: Enforcing Mandatory Fields Using UI Policies and Migrating Changes with Update Sets

1. Introduction

The ideation phase is the initial stage of the project development lifecycle where the core idea of the project is identified and clearly defined. In this stage, the development team focuses on understanding the problem, exploring possible solutions, and defining the objective of the project. For the project titled “**Enforcing Mandatory Fields Using UI Policies and Migrating Changes with Update Sets**,” the ideation phase focuses on improving data quality in ServiceNow forms and ensuring that configuration changes can be properly transferred between ServiceNow instances.

ServiceNow is widely used by organizations for IT Service Management (ITSM) activities such as incident management, problem management, and change management. These processes rely heavily on forms that users fill out to report issues or request services. However, in many cases users submit forms without completing all the necessary fields. Missing information can create confusion for support teams and may delay the resolution process. Therefore, ensuring that important fields are filled before form submission becomes an important requirement.

2. Problem Identification

During the ideation phase, the primary problem identified was **incomplete or inaccurate data entry in ServiceNow forms**. When users leave required fields empty, the support team may not receive sufficient information to understand the issue. This results in additional communication between users and technicians, which increases resolution time and reduces operational efficiency.

Another issue identified is related to **managing configuration changes across different ServiceNow environments**. Organizations usually maintain multiple instances such as development, testing, and production. Changes made in the development environment must be transferred safely to other environments. Without a proper migration process, configurations may be inconsistent or lost.

3. Proposed Solution

To address these challenges, the project proposes the use of **UI Policies** in ServiceNow to enforce mandatory fields dynamically. UI Policies are configuration tools that allow administrators to control form behavior without writing complex scripts. Using UI Policies, fields can be set as mandatory, read-only, or visible depending on specific conditions.

For example, when a user selects a specific **incident category**, additional fields such as subcategory or description can automatically become mandatory. This ensures that users provide complete and relevant information before submitting the form. As a result, support teams can analyze and resolve issues more efficiently.

4. Role of Update Sets

Another key concept explored during the ideation phase is the use of **Update Sets** for migrating configuration changes between ServiceNow instances. Update Sets allow developers and administrators to capture system modifications such as UI Policies, business rules, workflows, and form changes.

Once captured, these changes can be moved from the **development instance to testing and production instances** in a controlled and organized way. This ensures that all configurations are transferred accurately without manual recreation, reducing the risk of errors and inconsistencies.

5. Benefits of the Proposed Idea

The proposed solution offers several advantages for organizations using ServiceNow:

- Improves **data accuracy** by ensuring required fields are completed.
- Reduces **incident resolution time** by providing complete information to support teams.
- Enhances **system reliability** by ensuring consistent configurations across instances.
- Simplifies **deployment of changes** through the use of Update Sets.
- Reduces manual effort and configuration errors.

6. Feasibility and Implementation Considerations

During the ideation phase, the feasibility of implementing UI Policies and Update Sets was also evaluated. Both features are built-in capabilities of the ServiceNow platform, which makes them easy to implement without requiring complex programming skills. Administrators can configure UI Policies through the ServiceNow interface, making the solution simple and scalable.

Additionally, using Update Sets supports a structured development process where changes can be tested in the development environment before being deployed to production.

7. Conclusion

In conclusion, the ideation phase establishes the foundation of the project by identifying the issue of incomplete data entry in ServiceNow forms and proposing a practical solution using **UI Policies and Update Sets**. UI Policies help enforce mandatory fields to ensure accurate data collection, while Update Sets enable safe migration of configuration changes between ServiceNow environments.

The ideas developed during this phase provide a clear direction for the next stages of the project, including **requirement analysis, project planning, system design, development, and**

implementation. By improving data quality and ensuring reliable configuration management, the proposed system contributes to more efficient and structured service management processes.